MMSU's Commitment

Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

SDG 15.2.1 · Events about sustainable use of land

Support or organise events aimed to promote conservation and sustainable utilisation of the land, including forests and wild land.

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year)

CAFSD Graduands Plant Native Trees and Bamboo in the University Forest Reserves



CAFSD Graduating Class 2025 "Bamboo and Tree Planting Activity," University Forest Reserves, City of Batac, 2 July 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)



Bamboo planting site in the University Forest Reserve, Brgy. Mabaleng, 2 July 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

Some 230 graduating students of the College of Agriculture, Food and Sustainable Development (CAFSD) of Mariano Marcos State University (MMSU) planted trees and bamboo in the University Forest Reserves in Barangays Payao and Mabaleng, City of Batac, on July 2, 2025. The activity was led by CAFSD OIC-Dean Charlie Batin and the 2025 CAFSD Graduating Class Student Council, with Dr. Joselito Rosario, Director for Agribusiness, and Mr. Bonne Jovie Orteza of the MMSU Bamboo Research and Development Center. MMSU President Virgilio Julius P. Manzano Jr. commended the class for leaving a lasting green footprint that will further preserve the forest areas managed by the university, and Mr. Hashler Garalde, a CAFSD alumnus representing the Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte, supported the college's sustainability efforts.

The graduands planted 120 seedlings of guijo and yakal, native dipterocarp timber species raised at the MMSU Central Nursery, in the Payao Forest Reserve, and 130 propagules of kawayan tinik, machiku and giant bamboo from the MMSU Bamboo Nursery in Mabaleng. The planting continues

CAFSD's pre-graduation tree-planting tradition, held in July 2024 by the BS Forestry graduates at Salinged Park, the university's ecological park, and repeated by the CAFSD Class of 2026 at the Payao Forest Reserve in June 2026.

Source

- MMSU News, "CAFSD graduands plant trees, bamboos in Batac forest reserves," 4 July 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2468/cafsd-graduands-plant-trees-bamboos-in-batac-forest-reserves
- MMSU News, "BS Forestry seniors leave green footprints with pre-graduation tree planting," 11 July 2024 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2065/bs-forestry-seniors-leave-green-footprints-with-pre-graduation-tree-planting

President's Farm Field Day Showcases Climate-Resilient Rice Varieties



President's Farm technology demonstration of inbred and hybrid rice varieties, 28 October 2025. (Photo: MMSU)



Farmers, LGU technicians and students at the President's Farm Field Day, in front of CAFSD. (Photo: MMSU)

On October 28, 2025, the MMSU Extension Directorate, with the Philippine Rice Research Institute (PhilRice) Batac Branch, held the President's Farm Field Day: A Technology Showcase in front of the College of Agriculture, Food and Sustainable Development. Farmers and farmer-leaders, agricultural technicians from Ilocos Norte local government units, BS Agriculture students, and MMSU and PhilRice rice specialists viewed eight rice varieties grown under wet-season conditions.

The varieties included four newly released by PhilRice, two public hybrids, and two suited to saline and rainfed conditions, among them NSIC Rc 686 (Salinas 39) and NSIC Rc 650 (Sahod Ulan 36), giving farmers options for saline-affected and rainfed fields. Speakers included MMSU President Dr. Virgilio Julius P. Manzano Jr., Extension Director Dr. Marlowe Aquino, and former MMSU President and PhilRice Executive Director Dr. Santiago R. Obien.

Source

- MMSU News, "MMSU President's Farm showcases 8 rice varieties," 4 November 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2665/mmsu-presidents-farm-showcases-8-rice-varieties

2025 International Day for Biological Diversity Wildlife Photo Contest



Contest poster with the animal-photography ethical guidelines (deadline 30 May 2025).



Winner Chris Jeremiah C. Antonio receives his certificate from Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales, Chief of Sustainability and Futures Thinking.

MMSU, through its Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking, marked the 2025 International Day for Biological Diversity with a Wildlife Photo Contest that invited the university community to document local wildlife and promote awareness of biodiversity conservation. Entrants followed animal-photography ethical guidelines: avoiding flash and loud noises, never using bait or food lures, following local laws and warning signs, keeping clear of nesting sites and sensitive habitats, and captioning photographs honestly. Entries were received until May 30, 2025.

Chris Jeremiah C. Antonio, a third-year BA Communication student, was named winner and received a ₱1,000 gift voucher and a certificate from Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales, Chief of Sustainability and Futures Thinking.

Source

- MMSU SDG 15 Life on Land report (2025), Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking